



THE VAULT

The Cover Letter

Your introduction, composed with restraint

THE PRIVATE CONCIERGE ACADEMY

Maison Amarine · Confidential · For the use of our mentees only

Short, warm, impeccably discreet

A cover letter in private service does one thing: it makes the reader want to meet you. It does not argue, it does not plead, and it never repeats the CV. Twelve lines is generous. Six is often better.

The tone is the message. A letter that is calm, precise and free of flourish tells them exactly what you will be like in their home. A letter that tries too hard tells them that too.

The four movements

- I. Why this house, this family, this role. One sentence, and it must be specific. A letter that could have been sent to anyone is read as such.
- II. What you have carried. One or two proofs, drawn from experience, with a number if you have one.
- III. What you understand about the role that a stranger would not. This is where you are chosen.
- IV. A close without insistence. Offer yourself for a conversation, and stop.

The model

For a private concierge position, through an agency, with a discreet reference to what the role truly asks.

Dear Ms Lawrence,

You are seeking a private concierge for a family who move often between two residences and who value, above all, that nothing about their life should require their attention twice. That is the work I know, and the work I care for.

For the past three years I have run the personal affairs of a family across four residences: their vendors, their budgets, their journeys, and the two large house projects that would have disrupted their year had they been managed less closely. They were not disrupted. I hold a household budget cleanly, I report before I am asked, and I have never once been the reason a plan had to be repeated.

What I have learned in that time is that the difficulty is rarely the request. It is being the person to whom the request can be entrusted, and remaining that person on the day everything moves at once.

I would be glad to meet the family, or to speak with you first, at whatever moment suits them. References are available with the consent of the household.

With my sincere regards,

Claire Duval

What to remove before you send

- “I am writing to apply for the position of...”, they know. Begin at the second sentence.
- “I believe I would be a great fit.”, belief is not evidence. Give them the evidence and let them believe.
- Any adjective about yourself. Let the facts do it, or let it go.
- The name of any former principal. Even here. Especially here.
- An exclamation mark. There is no place for one in this world.

A note on the medium

If you write by email, the letter is the email. Never attach it. An attachment asks the reader to work, and the first thing you are demonstrating is that with you, nothing is ever work.